

DOCUMENT 04

Recipes Guide

Thirteen master lighting setups, pre-built and ready to shoot.

What Are Recipes?

Recipes are 13 pre-built lighting setups curated by master photographers. Each recipe packages a named lighting pattern with specific modifier choices, gear requirements, and a philosophy statement explaining why the setup works.

Recipes are not user-editable templates. They are reference setups — learning tools that show how canonical lighting patterns translate to real gear decisions. They also serve as priors for the recommendation engine.

KEY DISTINCTION

- Recipes are read-only reference material. Use them to learn patterns, not to replace custom analysis. For your specific reference image, always run Analyze first.

The 13 Master Recipes

Recipe Name	Pattern	Difficulty	Gear Flex
Beauty Clamshell	Clamshell	Medium	2/5
Dramatic Rembrandt	Rembrandt	Hard	3/5
Clean Corporate Headshot	Loop	Easy	4/5
Editorial Hard Light	Hard Direct	Medium	3/5
Natural Window Light Look	Window / Soft Ambient	Easy	5/5
High Key Product	Flat High Key	Medium	3/5

Low Key Moody	Split / Rembrandt	Hard	3/5
Butterfly / Paramount	Butterfly	Medium	3/5
Caravaggio Chiaroscuro	Single Hard Source	Expert	2/5
Vermeer Window	Directional Soft	Medium	4/5
Avedon High-Key	Flat Shadowless	Hard	2/5
Penn Precision Beauty	Modified Clamshell	Expert	2/5
Heisler Adaptive Rembrandt	Rembrandt + Fill	Hard	3/5

Recipe Detail — Beauty Clamshell

The Beauty Clamshell is the canonical beauty portrait setup: a large soft source directly above camera axis, a reflector or second source directly below, creating symmetric shadow fill and a distinctive double catch-light.

Field	Value
Pattern	Clamshell
Key Light	Large octa or beauty dish above camera axis — 12–18 inches above lens level
Fill	White reflector or strip box below lens — fills under chin and cheekbone shadows
Modifiers	Beauty dish + diffusion sock OR 100cm octa; fill V-flat at 45°
Power Ratio	Key: base exposure · Fill: –1 to –1.5 stops
Gear Flex	2/5 — requires specific modifier; reflector substitute loses symmetry

Use Case	Beauty, cosmetics, clean portraiture
Why It Works	Eliminates under-eye shadows; maximizes catch-light size; flatters most faces

How to Use Recipes

Browse Recipes

1 Navigate to Recipes in the nav bar. Filter by pattern, difficulty, or gear flexibility.

Study the Setup

2 Read the pattern, modifiers, and "Why It Works" for lighting education.

Run a Matching Analysis

3 Upload a reference photo inspired by the recipe; NGW confirms how closely it matches.

Shoot Mode from Recipe

4 Launch Shoot Mode with a recipe as your target setup instead of an analyzed photo.